that high standard infrastructure based on transparency and market viability should be promoted for the larger benefit of the region.

In the light of the pandemic, it was to only be expected that the Quad would come together in its vaccine supply endeavours. The group cooperated to expand manufacturing capacity of World Health Organization (WHO)-approved vaccines and collaborate with COVAX to track demand, as also with WHO to overcome vaccine hesitancy. On its part, India has provided more than half a million ‘Made in India’ vaccine doses to Cambodia and Thailand under the Quad Vaccine Partnership. Other notable areas of cooperation have been the Quad Data Satellite Portal and the STEM fellowships. The analysis on climate change risks and sustainable use of oceans and marine resources is high on the Quad agenda.

An important outcome from the Tokyo Summit in 2022 was the Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) partnership for the Indo-Pacific. This has a symbolic resonance, given the 2004 tsunami cooperation. These initial agreements have now led to the finalization of the Quad’s standard operating procedures. At a time when climate events are proliferating and global responses are declining, this will fill a significant gap.

By the time the Quad leaders assembled in Hiroshima in May 2023, they were ready to jointly articulate their most comprehensive collective outlook to date. This included a detailed agenda that addressed climate action, supply chains, pandemic and health concerns, infrastructure, education, connectivity, digital capabilities, standards, R&D, cyber and space technologies and maritime domain awareness. They issued three statements of principles: on clean energy supply chains, critical and emerging technology standards, and secure software. Their global and regional perspectives, while reiterating many known positions, clearly highlighted where the convergences were strongest. As each year, indeed each meeting, widens the ambit of cooperation, it is increasingly clear that Quad is here not just to stay but to grow steadily.

An interesting feature of the evolution of the Quad, and it is still continuing, is how the comfort levels are constantly encouraging exploration of new areas. In early 2023, this was visible in domains ranging from maritime security, multilateralism, counter-terrorism and HADR. When it came to the IORA, the Quad members committed to working more intensively together, as they visibly did in the 2023 Colombo meet. The